tools freely, every attempted action passes through a policy enforcement point (PEP) before execution. Figure 18.2 illustrates this architecture.

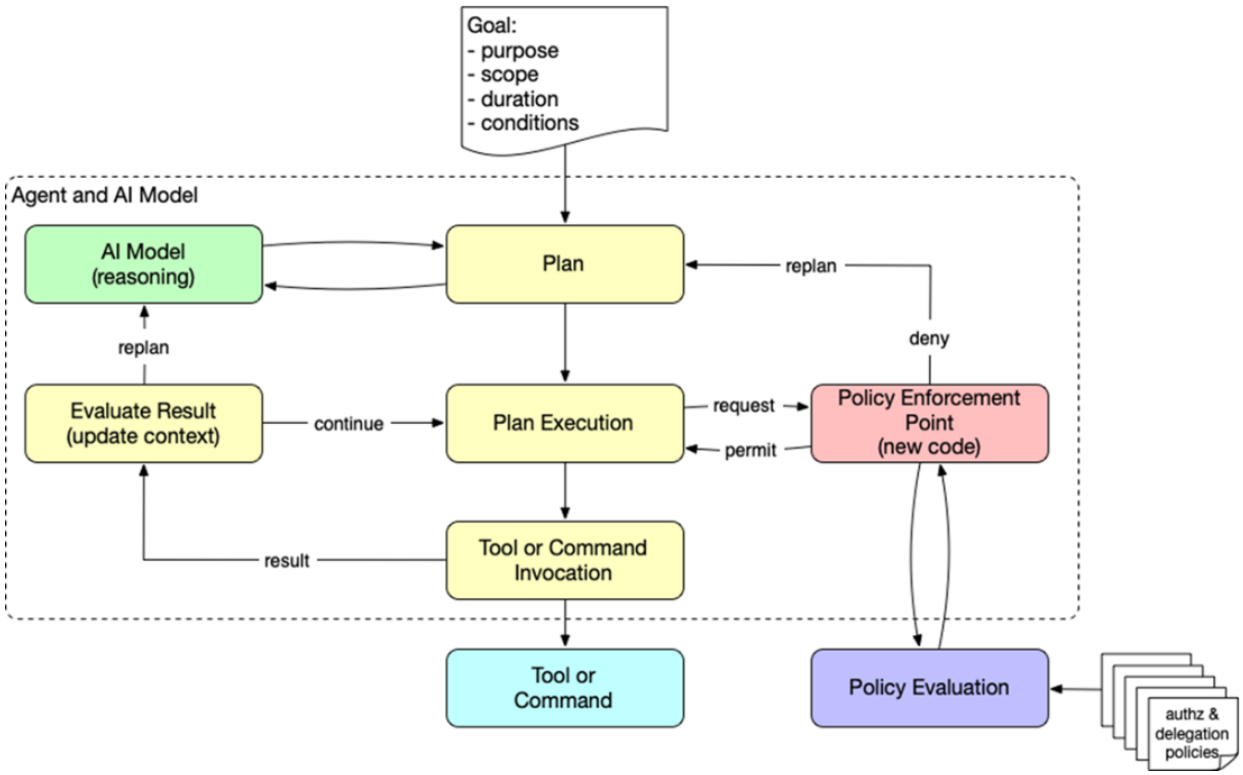


Figure 18.2 A policy-aware agent loop. An agent iteratively plans and executes actions while a policy enforcement point evaluates each proposed action before execution. Authorization decisions become part of the agent's feedback loop, allowing it to revise its plan when actions are denied.

Each time the agent proposes an action—such as reading a document or calling an API—the request is intercepted by the PEP. The enforcement point then constructs an authorization request using the familiar PARC model:

- **principal**—the agent invoking the tool
- **action**—the operation requested (for example, `documents.read`)
- **resource**—the target system or data
- **context**—task-specific information such as the customer, file path, or environment

This request is sent to the policy decision point (PDP), where Cedar evaluates it against the relevant policies. If the decision is `permit`, the tool